

RAZOR

UI / UX DESIGN DOCUMENT

"The old world is tearing apart. A new world is being born."

Designer

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01 — GAME OVERVIEW

Core Identity

RAZOR is a third-person tactical near-future competitive PVP shooter built around a single design principle: intensity. Every system, every mechanic, every UI decision exists in service of delivering the most intense competitive experience possible.

Genre: Third-person tactical competitive PVP shooter

Setting: Near future — 10 years from present. Decaying world. Grounded realistic technology. Stylized but real.

Perspective: Third person

Movement: Arc Raiders style — weighted, physical, momentum based. Operators feel heavy and real.

Combat: Pure gunplay. No abilities. Sophisticated execution.

Structure: Round based economy

Core Identity: Intensity

Tagline

"The old world is tearing apart. A new world is being born."

World Description

Ten years from now. The geopolitical order has fractured. Nation states compete with private factions, criminal networks, and ideological movements for control of the most valuable resource left: information. The physical world decays — infrastructure crumbling, cities hollowing out, institutions losing legitimacy. But the technology of conflict has never been more advanced. Operators move through deteriorating environments using cutting-edge augmented reality systems, advanced weapons, and near-future tactical equipment. The contrast between the decaying world and the sharp technology cutting through it is RAZOR's visual and thematic heart.

02 — FACTIONS

Four factions compete in RAZOR. Each has its own ideology, aesthetic identity, and reason for fighting. All four send operators to fight over BREACH objectives — data, information, and the power it represents.

The Government

The establishment. Militarized. Bureaucratic. Trying to maintain order in a world slipping away from them. The most well-equipped faction — but morally compromised. Think NSA, military contractors, surveillance state infrastructure.

Aesthetic: Official equipment showing heavy wear. Things that were once pristine now deteriorating like the institution they represent. Professional but decaying.

The Anarchists

Anti-establishment. Chaotic but principled in their own way. Fighting against the system entirely. Improvised equipment. Reclaimed technology. Nothing factory issued — everything modified, repurposed, personalized.

Aesthetic: Raw, aggressive, handmade. Spray paint and salvaged gear. Intentionally imperfect.

The Defectors

Former government operators who broke away to build something new. They believe in order — but not this order. They understand the system because they built it. The most narratively complex faction.

Aesthetic: Government equipment stripped of official insignia. Professional but deliberately unmarked. Somewhere between clean and raw.

The Criminals

Opportunists in a collapsing world. Fighting for resources, territory, and power. Not ideological — transactional. Sophisticated criminal networks with access to black market military equipment.

Aesthetic: Expensive and illegal. High-end black market technology. Sleek but dangerous.

Faction UI Skins

Each faction has its own visual treatment of the HUD. The core information architecture stays identical across all factions — competitive integrity requires this. But the visual language of that information changes completely.

- Government: Clean military-spec displays. Official typography. Digital readouts that feel like actual government technology. Slightly deteriorating — glitches, wear, bureaucratic inefficiency showing through.
- Anarchists: Rough. Hand-rendered quality. Stenciled typography. Repurposed displays. Spray paint textures. Intentionally imperfect.
- Defectors: Government base stripped of official identity. Clean structure but deliberately unmarked. The most minimal of the four.
- Criminals: Expensive and illegal. High-end black market technology. Sleek. The only faction whose UI feels luxurious.

03 — GAMEPLAY SYSTEMS

BREACH — The Objective

BREACH is RAZOR's core objective system. One team deploys a BREACH device on a target terminal — servers, command systems, encrypted data vaults. The BREACH device physically interfaces with the terminal and begins extracting or corrupting data. The defending team tries to sever the connection before the hack completes.

The BREACH has a timer. At zero, the data transfer completes. The attacking faction achieves its objective. The defending faction can sever the BREACH by physically disconnecting the device or deploying a counter-hack that interrupts the transfer.

The BREACH replaces the traditional bomb plant/defuse — but grounded entirely in RAZOR's world of information warfare. Every round has a story. Every BREACH attempt means something.

Destruction System

RAZOR combines two distinct destruction philosophies simultaneously:

- Large-scale environmental destruction — The Finals style. Entire sections of a map can collapse. Floors give way. Walls come down. The environment becomes an active participant in the combat.
- Fine tactical destruction — Rainbow Six Siege style. Precise breaching of individual surfaces. Specific walls, floors, and ceilings destroyable with intention. Tactical geometry created and destroyed deliberately.

Destruction means the pre-round scan becomes increasingly inaccurate as a match progresses. The tension between what the scan showed and what the environment actually looks like is a core tactical element.

Round Based Economy

Players earn currency through round performance — kills, objective play, round wins. Between rounds they purchase weapons, equipment, and utilities from the buy phase. Economy management across a match is a core competitive skill. Losing money means losing options. Pressure compounds across rounds.

Music

Dark techno. The music of underground spaces, industrial decay, and human beings pushing past comfortable limits. The tempo mirrors the gameplay arc structurally — builds slowly with the round's tension, drops at the moment of first contact, cuts to complete silence at round end. The silence after a lost BREACH is RAZOR's most powerful sound design moment.

04 — THE SCAN SYSTEM

RAZOR's most innovative tactical feature. The Scan System replaces the traditional minimap entirely — delivering superior spatial information in a way that is grounded in the world's fiction and more immersive than any flat map abstraction.

How It Works

Operators use augmented reality technology — advanced glasses or contact lenses — to scan the entire map. That scan creates a static three-dimensional tactical picture of the environment. Full vertical information. Every floor. Every room. Every breach point. Every angle.

The scan is static. It shows the map as it was scanned — not what is happening in real time. No player positions. No live information. Operators enter each round with complete spatial understanding of the environment but zero real-time enemy intelligence.

On-Demand Activation

Players activate the scan at any point during a round by holding a designated input. The scan renders as a three-dimensional wireframe overlay in the augmented reality layer — cold grey steel lines on a dark background. Razor Red highlights breach points and destructible surfaces.

Team Marking

Within the scan, players can place markers at any three-dimensional point in the environment. These markers persist when the player exits the scan — appearing as world-space AR indicators visible to all teammates. Markers communicate tactical intent: enemy last known position, recommended breach points, danger zones, movement suggestions.

Destruction Divergence

As rounds progress and destruction accumulates, the scan becomes increasingly inaccurate. The divergence between the clean pre-round scan and the chaotic reality of the destructible environment mid-round is visible and tactically significant. The scan shows a wall. You can see through where it used to be. That tension is uniquely RAZOR.

Why No Minimap

Every function a minimap serves is replaced by RAZOR's spatial awareness systems — and replaced more effectively, more immersively, and more consistently with the world's fiction:

- Callout communication → Organic location language develops naturally through community. The marker system handles precision communication.
- Teammate position → Always visible as AR outlines through any surface. Full vertical awareness.
- Objective tracking → BREACH device has a permanent world-space AR signature visible through environment.
- Enemy intelligence → World-space enemy pulse at last known position. Threat pulse system for directional sound mapping.
- Map orientation → Learned through experience and the pre-round scan. No UI assistance.

Removing the minimap means player eyes never leave the world. The information comes to them — in the world, where the intensity lives.

05 — SPATIAL AWARENESS SYSTEM

RAZOR's complete AR spatial awareness system replaces the minimap across five distinct functions. Everything lives in the world through augmented reality. Nothing lives on a flat map abstraction.

Teammate Outlines

Teammates are always visible through augmented reality regardless of walls, floors, or distance. Not a dot on a map — actual operators visible as AR outlines through any surface. A single-pixel thin outline tracing the exact silhouette of the operator's body and equipment.

The outline has slight visual noise — not perfectly smooth. Slightly angular. Like a sensor rendering a human shape rather than an artist drawing one. No fill. No glow. No pulse animation during calm state. Just the line. Clean and precise.

Outline color is player-selected in settings — personal choice, like crosshair color. Creates genuine operator identity. One constraint: the enemy pulse color cannot be selected to prevent confusion.

Outline states communicate teammate status instantly:

- Fully visible outline: Teammate alive and operational
- Fragmented and incomplete outline: Teammate critically injured
- Outline disappears: Teammate dead. No dramatics. Just absence.
- Single sharp contraction pulse: Teammate taking damage

Enemy Intelligence — World Space Pulse

When an enemy is spotted by any teammate, their position briefly illuminates in the AR system as a world-space pulse at their last known position. The pulse fades over time — communicating that the information is becoming outdated. Not a minimap flash. An actual spatial indicator existing in the world.

Threat Pulse — Directional Sound Mapping

When an enemy fires within a certain radius, the AR system registers a spatial pulse at the directional origin of the sound. Not the enemy's exact position — the origin of the sound. A three-dimensional directional indicator existing in world space through the AR layer.

Above: the pulse appears above the operator's eyeline. Below: below. Behind a wall: the wall itself subtly pulses at the origin point. Grounded in reality — operators with AR technology would have spatial audio mapping. Delivers spatial awareness without revealing exact enemy position.

BREACH Objective Indicator

The BREACH objective has a permanent AR signature visible through environment within a certain radius. World-space. Floating above the terminal. Showing transfer percentage, progress arc, and status at all times.

BREACH status states:

- BREACHING: Percentage and arc in Razor Red. Hack active and dangerous.
- SEVERING: Transitions to cold precise white. Defender in control.
- BREACH COMPLETE: Full Hot Red with single sharp pulse. Hack succeeded.
- SEVERED: Completely dark. Clean and final.

06 — DESIGN PRINCIPLES

Five principles govern every UI decision in RAZOR. Every element is evaluated against all five before implementation.

Principle	Definition
01 — Precision over decoration	Every element earns its place. Nothing exists for beauty alone. If it does not serve the player's survival it does not exist on screen.
02 — The world bleeds through	The UI feels like actual technology existing in RAZOR's decaying world. Worn. Scratched. Weathered. Part of the game's material reality — not a clean overlay floating above it.
03 — Red means now	The accent color is reserved exclusively for critical information and moments of urgency. When red appears the player acts immediately. It never appears decoratively.
04 — Calm until it isn't	The HUD breathes with the game's emotional state. Quiet and minimal during slow intensity phases. Sharp and urgent during hyper stress moments. The UI responds to danger rather than constantly demanding attention.
05 — Destruction is information	Every piece of destruction information the UI communicates adds pressure. The wall is gone. The floor is compromised. The scan is outdated. Nowhere is safe.

07 — VISUAL IDENTITY

Core Visual DNA

Base: Cold grey steel. Dark. Heavy. Industrial decay. Desaturated world.

Accent: Sharp red. Precise. Electric. Advanced technology cutting through the grey.

Texture: Scratched metal. Worn concrete. Weathered surfaces. Nothing pristine.

Typography: Utilitarian. Military spec. Condensed. Built for instant readability under pressure.

Feel: The grey is the world dying. The red is the technology keeping operators lethal inside it.

Typography System

Two typefaces only. Everything in RAZOR uses one or the other.

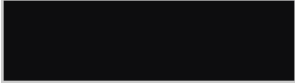
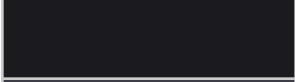
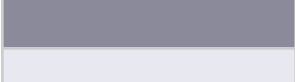
Typeface	Role	Usage
Eurostile Extended	Primary	All critical HUD information. Health numbers. Ammo counts. Round timer. Money. All caps. Maximum readability under pressure.
Din Condensed	Secondary	Labels, kill feed, secondary information, menu navigation. German engineering precision. Functional without being cold.

Typography Rules

- All caps for all critical HUD elements
- Never more than two weights — regular and bold
- Minimum 14px for any in-game text
- Letter spacing slightly open for readability under stress
- No decorative typography anywhere

Color System — Base Palette

Swatch	Name	Hex	Usage
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	Steel Black	#0D0D0F	Primary background. Deepest UI layer.
	Gunmetal	#1A1A1F	Secondary background. Panels and containers.
	Worn Grey	#3D3D45	Borders, dividers, inactive elements.
	Pale Steel	#8A8A9A	Secondary text, labels, inactive states.
	Off White	#E8E8F0	Primary text, active elements, primary information.

Color System — Accent Palette

Swatch	Name	Hex	Usage
	Razor Red	#CC1122	Primary accent. Critical information only.
	Hot Red	#FF1A2E	Full intensity alerts. Critical health. Urgent warnings.
	Dim Red	#661122	Subdued backgrounds behind red elements.

Color System — Functional Palette

Swatch	Name	Hex	Usage
	Armor Blue	#4A7FA5	Armor display only.
	Money Green	#4A7A4A	Economy display only.
	Warning Amber	#B87A1A	Structural integrity warnings. Destruction system.
	Death White	#FFFFFF	Kill feed. Death notifications. Maximum urgency moments.

Color Rules

- Razor Red appears only for critical information and urgent states — never decoratively
- Background layers never exceed Gunmetal — keep it dark and heavy
- Maximum three colors visible simultaneously in HUD during calm phase

- During hyper stress moments red dominates — other colors recede

Texture Language

Three texture types used throughout RAZOR's UI. All applied subtly — present enough to feel real, never overwhelming.

- Scratched Steel: Subtle diagonal scratch marks on UI panel backgrounds. Like equipment that has been through combat.
- Worn Edge: Panel borders slightly degraded. Corners imperfect. Nothing factory fresh. Applied to all UI containers.
- Static Interference: Micro-animation. Occasional single-frame glitch on display elements. Like a screen that has taken damage. Used sparingly — only during high stress moments.

08 — HUD DESIGN

The RAZOR HUD is the most critical design system in the game. Players look at the same HUD for thousands of hours. Every pixel placement serves a specific purpose. The HUD breathes with the game state — minimal and receded during calm phases, sharp and urgent during combat.

HUD Layout Logic

Position	Element and Rationale
Bottom Left	Health and Armor. Player eye naturally rests bottom left during gameplay. Critical survival information lives here. Health: large Eurostile number. Off White normally — transitions through pale red to Hot Red as health decreases. Armor: smaller number directly below in Armor Blue. Disappears completely at zero.
Bottom Right	Weapon and Ammo. Current weapon name in Din Condensed. Magazine count large in Eurostile. Reserve count smaller beside it. Secondary weapon thumbnail above primary. Grenade and equipment icons in a tight horizontal row.
Top Left	Round Score. Team A vs Team B rounds won. Minimal. Always visible but never demanding attention. Din Condensed. Pale Steel — recedes during action.
Top Center	Round Timer. Single most glanced-at element in competitive FPS. Dead center top. Large enough to read in peripheral vision. Eurostile. Off White normally. Transitions to Razor Red in final 10 seconds.
Top Right	Money. Current money display. Money Green. Din Condensed. Quiet during play. Prominent during buy phase.
Right Side	Kill Feed. Vertical stack descending from top right. Maximum 5 entries visible. Fades after 5 seconds. Weapon icons between player names. Player kills highlighted in Razor Red.
Center	Crosshair. Fully customizable. Default: minimal four-line gap crosshair. Off White with Razor Red center dot option.
Contextual — Bottom Center	Structural Integrity Indicator. Normally completely invisible. Appears only when cover is taking structural damage. Subtle arc showing integrity percentage. Warning Amber transitioning to Hot Red as collapse approaches. Disappears when player moves away.

Dynamic HUD States

RAZOR's HUD responds to game state dynamically. This is the technical implementation of the "Calm until it isn't" principle.

State	Description
Calm State (Default)	HUD at 70% opacity. Slightly receded. Only crosshair and round timer at full opacity. Player has maximum visual connection to the game world.
Alert State	Triggered by taking damage. All HUD elements snap to 100% opacity instantly. Health pulses once in Razor Red. Directional damage indicator appears briefly. Returns to calm 3 seconds after last damage.
Critical State	Health below 25%. Health number permanently Hot Red. Subtle red vignette at screen edges. Heartbeat micro-animation on health display. Everything else recedes to draw eye to health.
Hyper Stress State	Multiple simultaneous triggers — taking damage while ammo critical while structural integrity warning active. All systems fire simultaneously. Red dominates. Everything communicating urgency at once. This is the moment RAZOR's UI earns its design.

09 — UI INVENTORY

Every UI system that requires design in RAZOR. This inventory serves as the complete checklist for the design process.

HUD — Always Visible

- Health display
- Armor display
- Current weapon and ammo — magazine and reserve
- Secondary weapon indicator
- Grenade and equipment slots
- Round timer
- Score display — rounds won per team
- Money display
- Kill feed
- Crosshair
- Structural integrity indicator — contextual destruction system

Spatial Awareness — AR Systems

- Teammate outline system — player-colored, state-communicating
- Enemy world-space pulse — last known position, time-limited
- Threat pulse — directional sound mapping in AR space
- BREACH objective AR indicator — world-space, status-communicating
- Team marker system — scan-placed, world-space persistent

Scan System

- On-demand activation and deactivation
- Three-dimensional wireframe map render
- Breach point and destructible surface highlighting
- Team marker placement interface
- Destruction divergence visualization

Buy Phase

- Weapon category navigation
- Primary weapons grid
- Secondary weapons grid
- Equipment and grenades
- Current money display
- Team economy overview
- Round history display
- Loadout summary

Round End Screen

- Round winner announcement
- MVP highlight
- Individual performance summary
- Economy display going into next round

Death Screen

- Killer identification
- Weapon used
- Spectate options
- Round timer remaining
- Team overview

Match Overview — Scoreboard

- Full team statistics
- Round history
- Individual player stats
- Economy overview

Settings and Menus

- Main menu
- Game settings
- Crosshair customization
- UI customization — faction skin selection
- Teammate outline color selection
- Audio settings

10 — EMOTIONAL ARC OF A ROUND

RAZOR's UI is designed to deliver a specific emotional experience across the arc of a single round. Every design decision maps to this arc.

Phase	Player Experience	UI Behavior
Pre-round Scan	Held breath. Meditative. Planning.	Nearly silent. Minimal pulse. Cold wireframe world rendered perfectly before humans tear it apart.
Slow Intensity	Watchful. Every decision weighted.	HUD at 70% opacity. Receded. Holding its breath with the player.
First Contact	Zero to everything. Car crash immediacy.	All elements snap to 100% opacity. Health pulses. Damage indicator cuts across screen. Kill feed activates. Teammate death registers as absent outline.
Active Combat	Controlled chaos. Maximum information.	Hierarchy rules. Red first. Off White second. Pale Steel third. Eye goes to red always.
Critical State	Barely holding on. Every second mattering.	Hot Red health. Red vignette. Structural integrity warning. Ammo flashing. All systems firing. The UI at maximum honest intensity.
Round End	The exhale. Weight of outcome.	Sudden silence. One clean cut. Result displayed. Cold and precise. Then economy screen. Next round already building.

11 — RESEARCH REFERENCES

Games to Study

- CS2 — Minimal HUD precision. Study how little it uses and why everything present is there.
- Valorant — Clean information hierarchy under competitive pressure. Sophistication and readability.
- The Finals — Large-scale destruction communication without HUD clutter.
- Rainbow Six Siege — Fine tactical destruction. Breachable surfaces. Structural integrity communication.
- Escape From Tarkov — Weight and realism of equipment-based UI. Near-future grounded aesthetic.
- The Division 2 — Near-future decay rendered beautifully.
- Dead Space — Diegetic UI masterclass. Everything on Isaac's suit. No traditional HUD elements.
- Halo Infinite — Gold standard sci-fi HUD integration. Feels like actual Spartan technology.
- Doom Eternal — Aggressive red used with surgical precision for critical information only.
- Hollow Knight — Minimal, atmospheric, perfectly integrated UI.
- Arc Raiders — Movement reference. Weight, momentum, physical operator feel.

Visual References Outside Games

- Brutalist architecture photography — concrete decay, industrial spaces losing function
- Military HUD displays — actual fighter jet cockpit interfaces, tactical display screens
- Eurostile and Din typeface specimens — study how they behave at multiple sizes under pressure
- War photography with advanced equipment present
- Urban decay photography — the specific texture of a world deteriorating

Film References

- Children of Men — definitive near-future decaying world aesthetic
- Sicario — tactical tension and precision. Slow burn to explosive contact.
- Blade Runner 2049 — decay meeting advanced technology. Cold beauty.
- Zero Dark Thirty — grounded military realism. Operators as professionals not heroes.

Music References

- Burial — urban decay and emotional weight through electronic music
- Objekt — precise, industrial, technically sophisticated dark techno
- Paula Temple — aggressive, political, sharp
- Blawan — brutal, industrial, physical
- Surgeon — clinical precision meets overwhelming intensity
- Ancient Methods — the heaviest end of dark techno for RAZOR's most intense moments

12 — NEXT STEPS

This document completes Phase 1 (Game Brief) and Phase 2 (Research Direction) of the RAZOR UI design process. The following phases remain:

Phase	Name	Deliverable
Phase 3	UI System Definition	Complete UI inventory confirmed. Information hierarchy defined per screen.
Phase 4	Visual Language	Mood board. Typography specimens. Color palette in use. Icon style defined.
Phase 5	Wireframes	Grayscale structure layouts for every screen in the UI inventory.
Phase 6	Visual Design	High fidelity Figma mockups. Full color. Full detail. HUD first.
Phase 7	Prototype and Test	Interactive Figma prototype. User testing. Iteration log.

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UI Design Document v1.0